Golden Spinach Crêpes

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Soft crêpes wrapped around creamy spinach and baked beneath a golden cheese topping make a lovely dish to bring to the table.

Serves 5–6 · Prep 25 min · Cook 45 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CRÊPES

- 50 g butter, melted and cooled, plus a little extra for the pan
- 250 g plain flour
- 1 tbsp icing sugar
- A pinch of salt
- 3 eggs
- 500 ml milk

FOR THE WHITE SAUCE AND SPINACH FILLING

- 2 tbsp butter or oil
- 2 tbsp plain flour
- 2 cups milk
- 1 tsp salt, adjusted to taste
- 1 tsp ground nutmeg
- 500 g spinach, washed and trimmed
- 1½ cups shredded mozzarella
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 1 cup shredded Emmental

METHOD

1. Make the crêpe batter. Place the flour, icing sugar and salt in a large bowl. Make a well in the centre and add the eggs. Whisk, gradually drawing in the flour and adding the milk a little at a time, until smooth. Whisk in the melted, cooled butter. Leave to rest for 20–30 minutes.
2. Prepare the spinach. Place the spinach in a large saucepan over medium heat with just the water clinging to its leaves. Cover and cook briefly until wilted. Drain, allow to cool slightly, then squeeze out as much liquid as possible. Chop roughly.
3. Make the white sauce. Heat the butter or oil in a saucepan over medium heat. Stir in the flour and cook for 1–2 minutes without browning. Gradually whisk in the milk until smooth. Simmer gently, stirring, until the sauce thickens enough to coat a spoon. Add the salt and nutmeg.
4. Prepare the filling and topping. Mix the three cheeses in a bowl. Reserve approximately one-third for the topping. Set aside about ¾ cup of the plain white sauce, then stir the spinach and remaining cheese into the sauce in the saucepan. Remove from the heat once the cheese has melted.
5. Cook the crêpes. Heat a lightly buttered non-stick crêpe pan over medium heat. Pour in a small ladle of batter and swirl to coat the base thinly. Cook until the edges lift and the underside is lightly golden, then turn and cook briefly on the other side. Repeat with the remaining batter.
6. Fill and arrange. Preheat the oven to 180°C. Spread a little of the reserved white sauce over the base of a baking dish. Divide the spinach filling between the crêpes, roll them up and arrange seam-side down in the dish.
7. Top and bake. Spoon the remaining reserved white sauce over the crêpes and scatter with the reserved cheese. Bake for approximately 20–25 minutes, until heated through and golden on top.
8. Leave to settle for 5 minutes before serving.

Tip

Rest the batter. This helps the flour hydrate and makes the crêpes easier to handle.